Emotions and feelings

The same green can awaken **calm** in one of us and **envy** in another, sometimes even both in one day.

Green can awaken **a breath**, **the wish to begin again** and **tiredness from endless caring**. There is no **single fixed effect**. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that may appear before you are even aware of them.

Calm and relief

A feeling of **a breath**, of slowing down and "now I do not have to try". **The body lets go, the shoulders drop**.

And why?

Nature, quiet, a forest. **Green is a colour that wants nothing from us**. And the body recognises that. It has neither the sharpness of red nor the urgency of yellow, so it more easily invites us to slow down.

Ask yourself

"When did I last really take a breath?"

Hope and a new beginning

The wish to **begin again**. A cautious hope that things can change.

And why?

Spring after winter, the first leaves, giving the green light. A colour that says "you can go on". It is a shortcut from nature and from traffic, not a miraculous property of the colour.

A question for you

"What in me wants to start growing?"

Care and the heart

Caring, **love**, **compassion**. But also tiredness from always looking after others.

And why?

Green is linked with the heart (in the yogic tradition with the Anahata chakra, more about it in the chapter on the rainbow). It is the colour of **someone who nourishes and cares**.

If I asked you now

"Whom do I give the most to and what do I give myself?"

Balance, or boredom?

A feeling that everything is "**just right**". Sometimes also a feeling that nothing is happening.

And why?

Green lies in the middle of the rainbow and somehow **balances** everything. It is calm, but **calm can also be boredom**.

Try asking yourself

"Is my "just right" calm, or empty?"

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Envy and comparing

A sharp feeling that the other woman has more, and straight after it shame that I feel it.

And why?

"Green with envy." **Green-eyed jealousy** already in Shakespeare. Envy does not say you are bad. **It tells you what you long for.**

Ask yourself

"Whom have I envied lately and what exactly?"

Nausea and oversaturation

"**I have had it up to here**." My stomach turns at what I have to take in.

And why?

When we feel sick our face turns green. Hence "green as bile". **The body sometimes speaks in green first** and only afterwards in words.

A question for you

"What do I no longer want to take in?"

I do not wear green, but I feel good in the forest

That makes sense. Clothing is part of how you want to show yourself to the world, the forest is an environment in which you **spend time**. A green jumper does not carry **daylight, the movement of leaves**, distance, sounds or relief from duties.

And why?

With trees you perceive much more than one colour. So you do not have to start liking green things for time outdoors to do you good. At home a photograph of trees may be more pleasant than a green wall. **You can work with a colour indirectly too**.

If I asked you now

"What from the forest could I bring home?"

When green recharges and when it makes you sleepy

When you say "that green recharges me", you may be describing that **the wish to do something** is coming back, **tension eases** or you concentrate better. When it "makes you sleepy", it may be **a pleasant slowing down**, but also an environment that is too dark and monotonous for you.

And why?

Colours can change mood and level of arousal. In experiments green is sometimes less exciting than red, but brightness and saturation also play a big role. A bright green over the whole screen can feel much more urgent than a muted green picture. Research does not support one identical reaction of all people to every green.

Try asking yourself

"Is it the colour, or the surroundings around it?"

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My green is not the same as your green

A colour itself **does not experience anything**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), **the experience sticks to it. The colour then becomes a shortcut**. It is enough to catch sight of it and the body knows whether it can relax or should withdraw. That is why **your own reaction** matters most.

- **A green school blackboard**
  For one of us concentration and nice memories, for another stress from being called up.
- **Forest and garden**
  Shelter and safety, or darkness and fear of who is hiding there.
- **A withered flower on the windowsill**
  For one calm, for another guilt that she forgot to water it again.
- **A hospital corridor**
  Relief and care, or fear and waiting for news.
- **Green from home**
  A little garden or herbal tea from grandmother. A safety that comes to mind without our thinking about it.

Why does it attract me when I am not actually calm?

Perhaps it does not express how you feel. Perhaps you are drawn to what you are missing. **After a long period of rush and duties** green can recall **an ordinary breath**. **A bench, a tree, a walk with no destination**. Sometimes you are tired precisely because you have not had anywhere to lay your head for a long time. And suddenly the sight of leaves calms you simply because they are **soft, quiet and want nothing from you**.

Why does it seem unpleasant to me, on the contrary?

A vivid green is too sharp for you. It reminds you of a hospital corridor, a school blackboard or an environment where you did not feel well. **A dislike of green does not have to mean** that you reject nature or calm. Perhaps you are only rejecting **a particular memory**. Try to tell whether all greens bother you or only a certain kind. A mossy leaf can be beautiful even if you would not want a bright green wall even in a photograph.

Some colours we put aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or stop buying plants. **It is a way of protecting ourselves**. And when we are ready, **green often comes back by itself**, first as a small plant on the windowsill, then as a walk.

When to add it and when to take it away

Add it where it calms you and opens something pleasant. **Take it away when you catch yourself** looking away from it, everything feels too heavy or you finally want more light and spark. Notice the changes. Sage does me good, a bright green disturbs me. In winter it attracts me more than in hot summer. These are your concrete experiences. They do not have to fit into one answer “I like green”.

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If I asked you now

“Which sentence about green is loudest in me and whose is it actually?”

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